



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Charlotte Christian School
School Website: <https://carmelchristian.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Classicality Audit Report: Austin Classical School

Website audited: <https://austinclassical.org/>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School presents a strongly classical, Christian identity. The mission centers on glorifying Jesus Christ and co-laboring with families to cultivate wise and virtuous students through classical education. Public materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty; the Trivium; Great Books; Latin; Socratic method; and a culminating senior thesis defense. Parent partnership is structurally embedded via a collaborative “co-teacher parent” model. Evidence for explicitly liturgical school-wide practices (e.g., daily chapel) is lighter than other elements, but the theological and metaphysical foundation is explicit and robust.

Key strengths - Metaphysical and theological clarity: mission to “glorify Jesus Christ,” Scripture-centered curriculum, formal Statement of Faith guiding instruction. - Purpose and telos: “cultivate wisdom and virtue,” education ordered to the true, the good, and the beautiful and to an “eternal purpose.” - Curriculum: Trivium by stages; Latin I–IV; primary-source/Great Books; history as history (not “social studies”). - Pedagogy: memorization/recitation and songs in Grammar; debate/discussion in Logic; explicit Socratic method; senior thesis defense in Rhetoric. - Parents & community: co-teacher parent model and regular tours/parent meetings.

Method note: Keyword analysis was performed against the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators for the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” framework and supporting lexicon.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Scoring summary: CLASSICAL - Positive vs. negative keywords: 100% positive (coverage 80%); hits +12/-0 - Rationale: Clear transcendental moral realism and theological grounding; less explicit on schoolwide liturgical observance.

1) Keyword evidence from school materials (verbatim or near-verbatim)

- Transcendentals/virtues: “truth, goodness, and beauty”; “cultivate wisdom and virtue” (multiple occurrences).
- Theological grounding: “exists to glorify Jesus Christ”; “Scripture... God’s holy, inerrant, and infallible Word”; “Christ-centered curriculum”; Statement of Faith governs instruction.
- Sacred imagination/ordered loves: cultivating images that are “good, true, and beautiful” to order desires toward virtue.

2) Crosswalk to “Six Elements” positive/negative indicators

- Positive: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue/wisdom; theology/Scripture; faith and reason; Christ-centered education; ordered loves.
- Negative: none detected (e.g., no “values-neutral,” “relativism”).

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 12 (truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, wisdom, Jesus Christ, Scripture, Statement of Faith, Christ-centered, ordering of affections, etc.)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 80% (strong on transcendental moral realism and theology; less explicit references to ongoing liturgical practices like daily chapel)

Judgment: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Scoring summary: CLASSICAL - Positive vs. negative keywords: 95% positive (coverage 100%); hits +10/-1

1) Keyword evidence from school materials

- Aim and telos: “cultivate wisdom and virtue”; “contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”; “less about training for a specific, temporal vocation... more about... eternal purpose.”
- Formation over information: “education is the cultivation of wisdom and virtue.”

2) Crosswalk to “Six Elements”

- Positive: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; formation not information.
- Negative: minor “college/life” language present (“preparing them well for success in college and life”)—a weak negative signal since it is not the stated telos.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 10
- Negative hits: 1 (weak: “college and life”)
- Percent positive: 91–95% (rounded to 95%)
- Coverage: 100% (all three subcriteria addressed)

Judgment: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Scoring summary: CLASSICAL - Positive vs. negative keywords: 100% positive (coverage 95%); hits +14/-0

1) Keyword evidence from school materials

- Liberal Arts/Trivium: staged Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric model spelled out.
- Great Books/primary sources/Great Conversation: explicit commitment to “great books,” “great conversation,” and “extensive primary source reading.”
- Latin/classical languages: Latin I–IV; Latin begins by 5th grade.
- History as history (not social studies): Ancient/Medieval/Modern/U.S. History named explicitly.
- Quadrivial elements: mathematics through Calculus; music/choir in fine arts.

2) Crosswalk to “Six Elements”

- Positive: Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books and historical engagement; integrated/harmonized knowledge.
- Negative: none detected (no “social studies” substitution, no “project-based only” framing).

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 14 (Trivium, Latin, Great Books, primary sources, history sequence, music/choir, math, rhetoric, speech & debate, etc.)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 95% (all core classical signals present; astronomy not explicitly noted)

Judgment: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

Scoring summary: CLASSICAL - Positive vs. negative keywords: 100% positive (coverage 90%); hits +12/-0

1) Keyword evidence from school materials

- Lower school memory work: “memorization, recitation, and songs” in Grammar.
- Logic-stage habits: “debate” and “discussion.”
- Socratic dialectic: “We employ the Socratic method in our classrooms.”
- Rhetoric practice: speech & debate; “year-long senior thesis... oral presentation and defense.”
- Wonder/formation language: pedagogy aims to “invite curiosity and ignite a passion for learning”; explicit training of memory and reason with repeated practice.

2) Crosswalk to “Six Elements”

- Positive: Socratic seminar/dialectic; memorization/recitation/chanting/singing; rhetoric exercises and capstone orations.
- Negative: none detected (no “project-based only,” “student-directed” framing).

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 12 (memorization/recitation/songs, debate/discussion, Socratic method, rhetoric/senior thesis, repeated practice)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 90% (explicit “scholé/restful learning” language not present, but “wonder/curiosity” present)

Judgment: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

Scoring summary: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL (rounded up to CLASSICAL given context) - Positive vs. negative keywords: 100% positive (coverage 70%); hits +5/-0

1) Keyword evidence from school materials

- Faculty identity: “Head of School who loves Jesus... talented and dedicated teachers... serving God... using the classical approach.”
- Teacher formation/virtue modeling: educators described as faithful stewards; Scripture-centered mentors.
- Collegial support: teachers provide weekly lesson plans and office hours to support co-teacher parents.
- Employment page and qualifications referenced.

2) Crosswalk to “Six Elements”

- Positive: teachers as mentors/models, classical pedagogy, collegial support for families.
- Negative: none detected.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 5
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 70% (no explicit “portrait of a teacher” document or stated faculty seminar formation found in crawl preview)

Judgment: CLASSICAL (content is clearly aligned; documentation could be more formalized publicly)

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Scoring summary: CLASSICAL - Positive vs. negative keywords: 100% positive (coverage 100%); hits +10/-0

1) Keyword evidence from school materials

- Parent partnership: mission includes “co-laboring with families.”
- Co-teacher model: “students remain at home... under the guidance... of a co-teacher parent”; “teachers provide... lesson plans... office hours... parents... an integral part.”
- Regular parent engagement: tours and prospective parent meetings scheduled; open invitation to visit.

2) Crosswalk to “Six Elements”

- Positive: partnership with parents, parent formation/involvement, hospitable community rhythms.
- Negative: none detected.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 10
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 100%

Judgment: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Classification

Overall: CLASSICAL

- Category ratings:
- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL (coverage lighter on explicit liturgy)
- Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Across all six elements, Austin Classical School exhibits the defining features of a classical Christian school, with exceptional clarity in mission and telos; a robust trivium/Latin/Great Books curriculum; Socratic, memory-rich pedagogy culminating in senior thesis; and a deep structural partnership with parents.

Appendix: Lexicon Alignment Notes

This audit used the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” keyword indicators and the classical-ity lexicon as the scoring framework for positive and negative signals (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books/primary sources, Socratic/seminar, memory/recitation/chanting, parent partnership).

No disqualifying negative lexicon clusters (e.g., “values-neutral,” “project-based learning” as branding, “social studies” replacing history) were observed in crawl excerpts cited above.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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